

Lecture 9

EE 421 / CS 425

Digital System Design

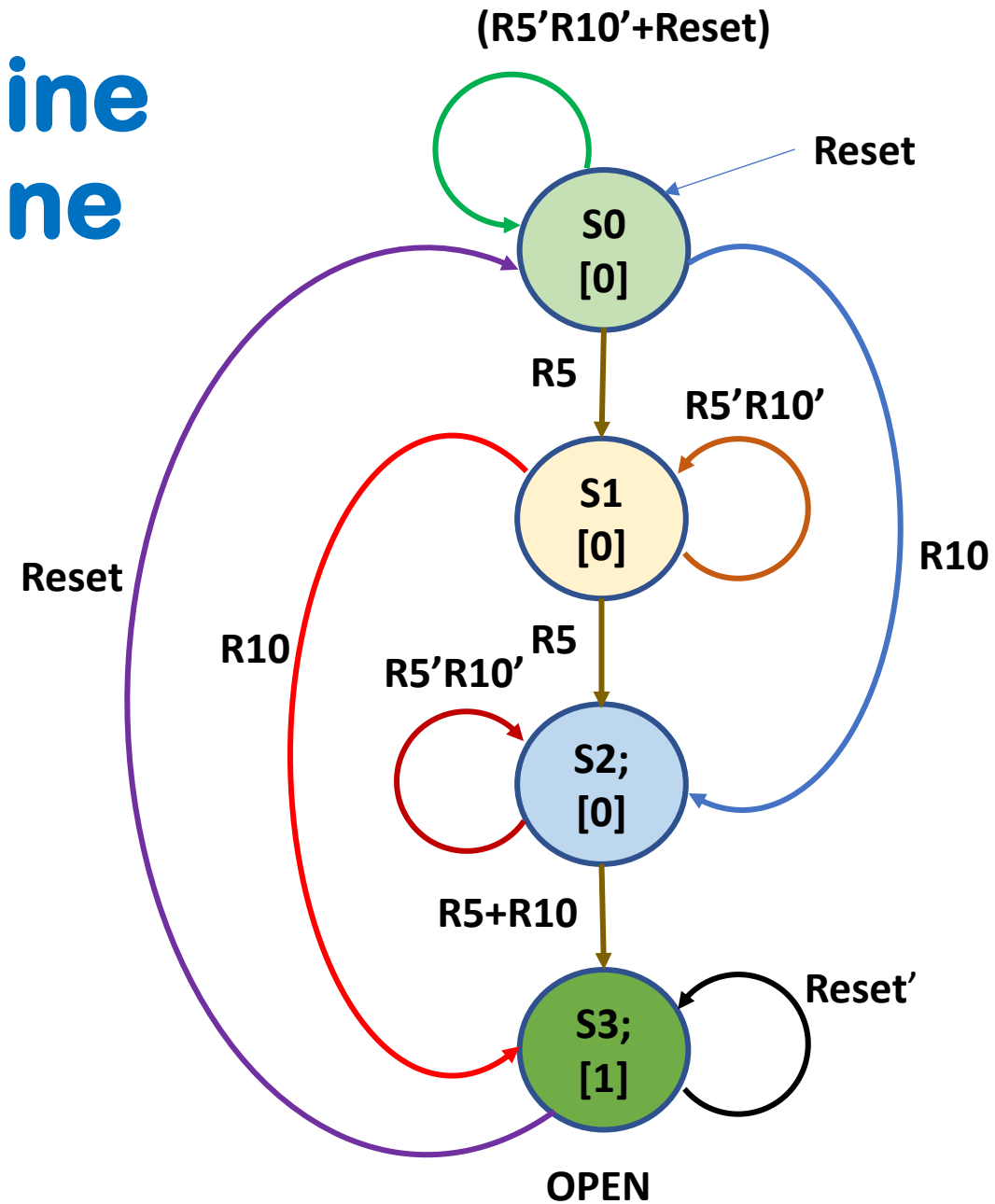
Fall 2026

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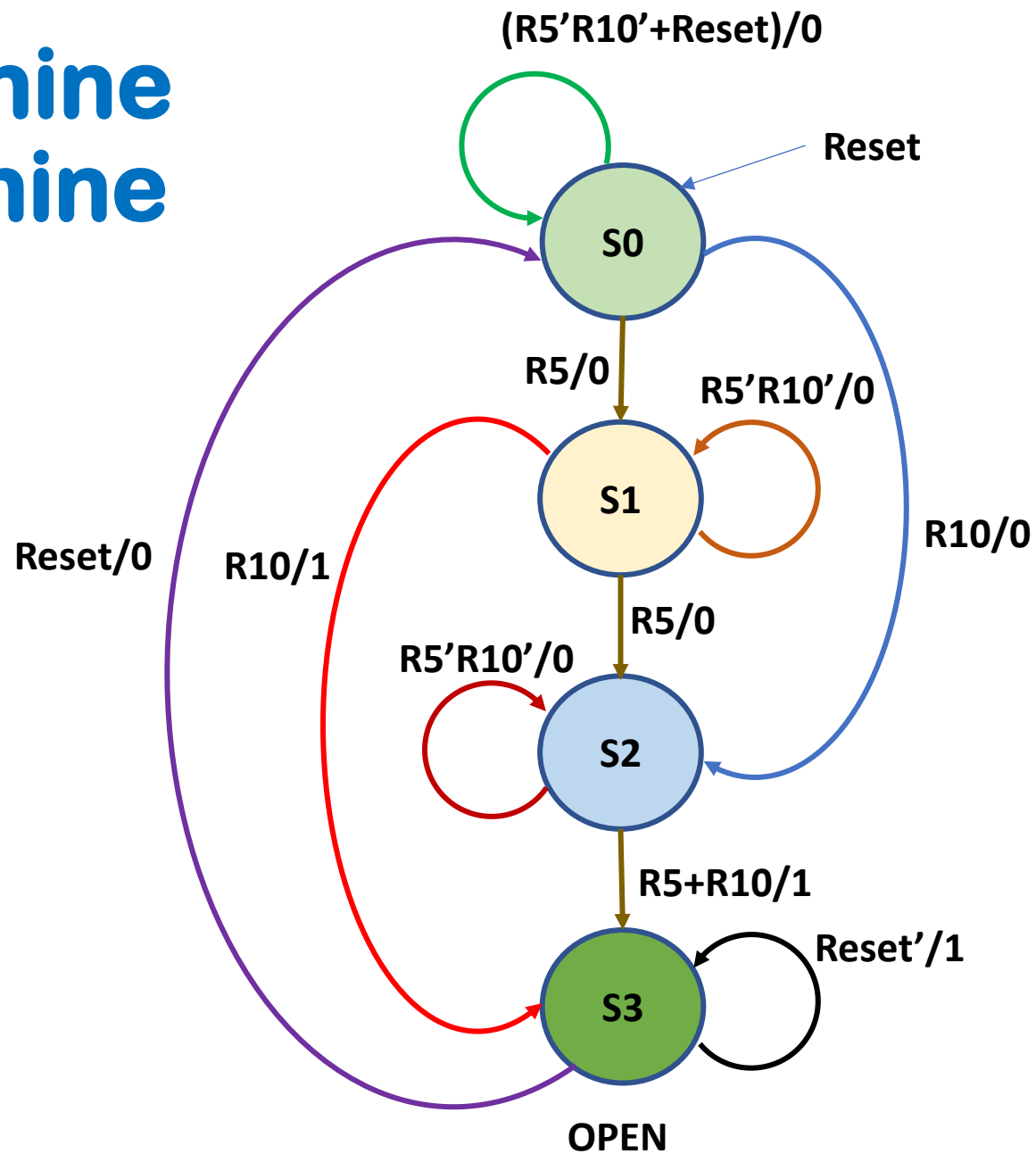
Topics

- (Leftover) Example of Vending Machine
- State Minimization
- Row Matching Method
- Using Implication Charts
- **QUIZ 2 today**

Moore State Machine for Vending Machine



Mealy State Machine for Vending Machine



Some Comparison Moore vs Mealy

- Mealy machine **requires fewer states** to reach output in comparison with Moore machine
- Mealy machine is **more susceptible to glitches**
- Explicit **output values** are shown in Mealy machine associated with each transition
- Output **changes after state** is changed in Moore machine
- Output in Moore machine **depends upon state only**; inputs can steer the output towards a particular state that affects output
- Output **depends upon present state and the present value** at the input; thus, output **can change immediately** with the change in input, independent of synchronous clock.

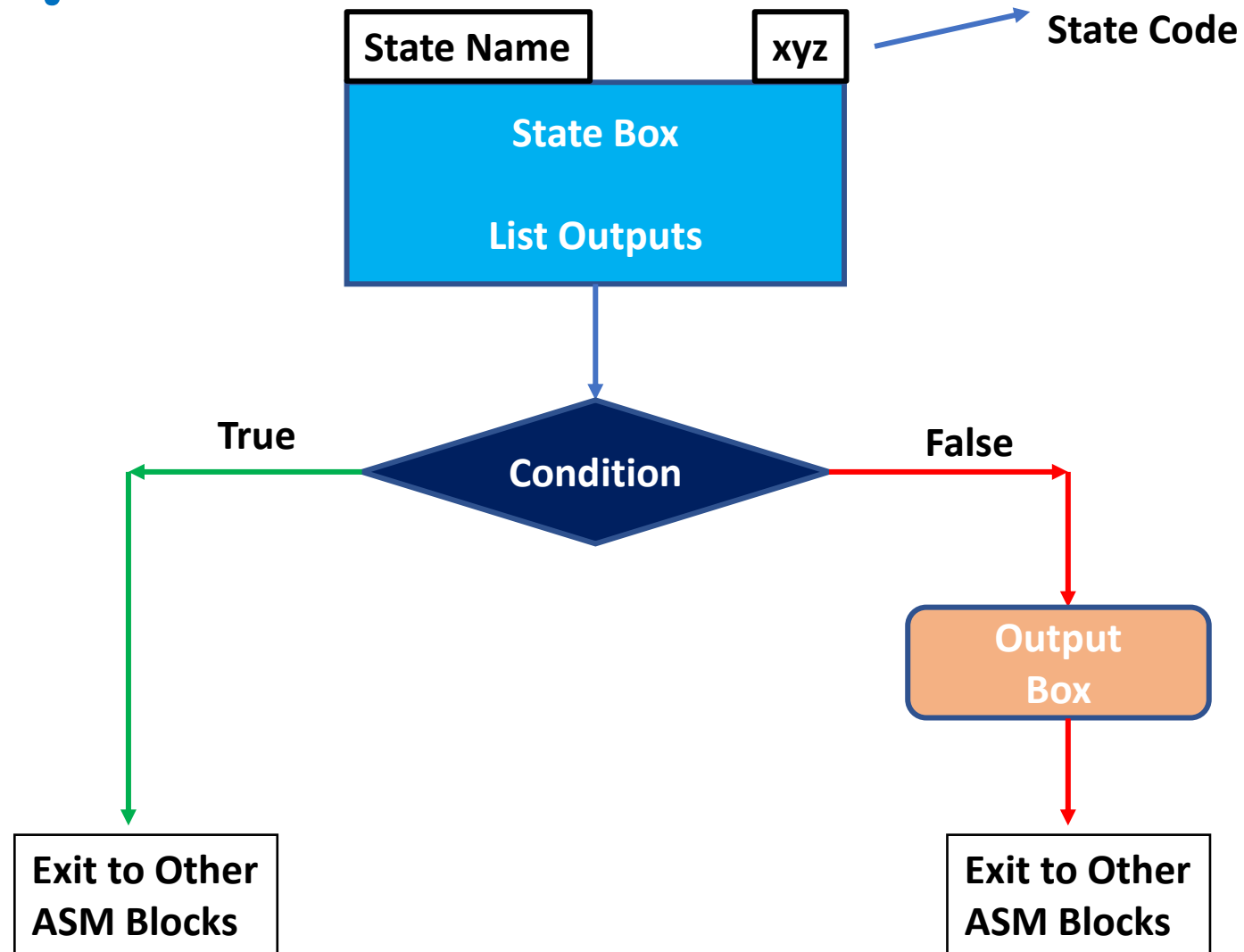
One Hot Encoding – one FF for each state

Present State				Inputs		Next State				Output OPEN
Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	R10	R5	D3	D2	D1	D0	Y
0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	
				0	1	0	0	1	0	
				1	0	0	1	0	0	
				1	1	X	X	X	X	
0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	
				0	1	0	1	0	0	
				1	0	1	0	0	0	1
				1	1	X	X	X	X	
0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	
				0	1	1	0	0	0	1
				1	0	1	0	0	0	1
				1	1	X	X	X	X	
1	0	0	0	X	X	1	0	0	0	1

D3 is directly
the Output and
Its State

The Design Becomes Simpler
Less Combinational Logic – At the Expense of Extra DFF

Algorithmic State Machine Description - ASMD



Finite State Machines: Moore Machine

File Edit Solve Scale Window Options Help

State Table

Check Input Run Stop

Present State	Inputs	Next State	Outputs
S0	R5 R10	S1 S2	0
S1	R5	S2	0
S2	R5 R10	S3 S3	0
S3	RESET	S0	1

State Diagram

SELECT DEL UNDO STATE LINK MOVE ZOOM ZOOM

```

graph TD
    S0((S0)) -- "R5 (0)" --> S1((S1))
    S0 -- "R10 (0)" --> S2((S2))
    S1 -- "R5 (0)" --> S2
    S2 -- "R5 (0)" --> S3((S3))
    S2 -- "R10 (0)" --> S3
    S3 -- "RESET (1)" --> S0
    style S0 fill:#fff,stroke:#f00,stroke-width:2px
    style S1 fill:#fff,stroke:#f00,stroke-width:2px
    style S2 fill:#fff,stroke:#f00,stroke-width:2px
    style S3 fill:#fff,stroke:#f00,stroke-width:2px
    
```

Trying FSM implementation
with WinlogiLab



Advantages of Minimum States

- Reduces number of logic gates and flipflops required for the implementation of state machine
- With fewer states, there are more don't care conditions into the next-state and output logic equations, making the implementation simpler.
- Simpler and less logic means shorter critical paths and higher achievable clock rate
- Fewer components also means shorter design time and lower manufacturing cost

State Minimization and Reduction

- State Reduction identifies and combines states that have equivalent behaviour
- Two states have equivalent behaviour iff:
 - for all input combinations, their outputs are the same, and
 - they change to the same or equivalent next state

State Reduction Algorithms

Begin with the symbolic state transition table.

We group together states that have the same state outputs (Moore Machine) or Transition outputs (Mealy Machine). These are potentially equivalent, since states cannot be equivalent if their outputs differ.

Next, examine the transitions to see if they go to the same next state for every input combination. If they do, the states are equivalent and can be combined into a renamed new state.

Then change all transitions into the newly combined states.

Repeat the process until no additional states can be combined.

Row Matching method for State Reduction

Use Case of a Four-Bit Sequence Detector

Specifications:

The machine has a single input X and a single output Z

The output is asserted after each 4-bit input sequence if the sequence contains binary Strings of “0110” or “1010”

The machine returns to “Reset” State after each 4-bit sequence

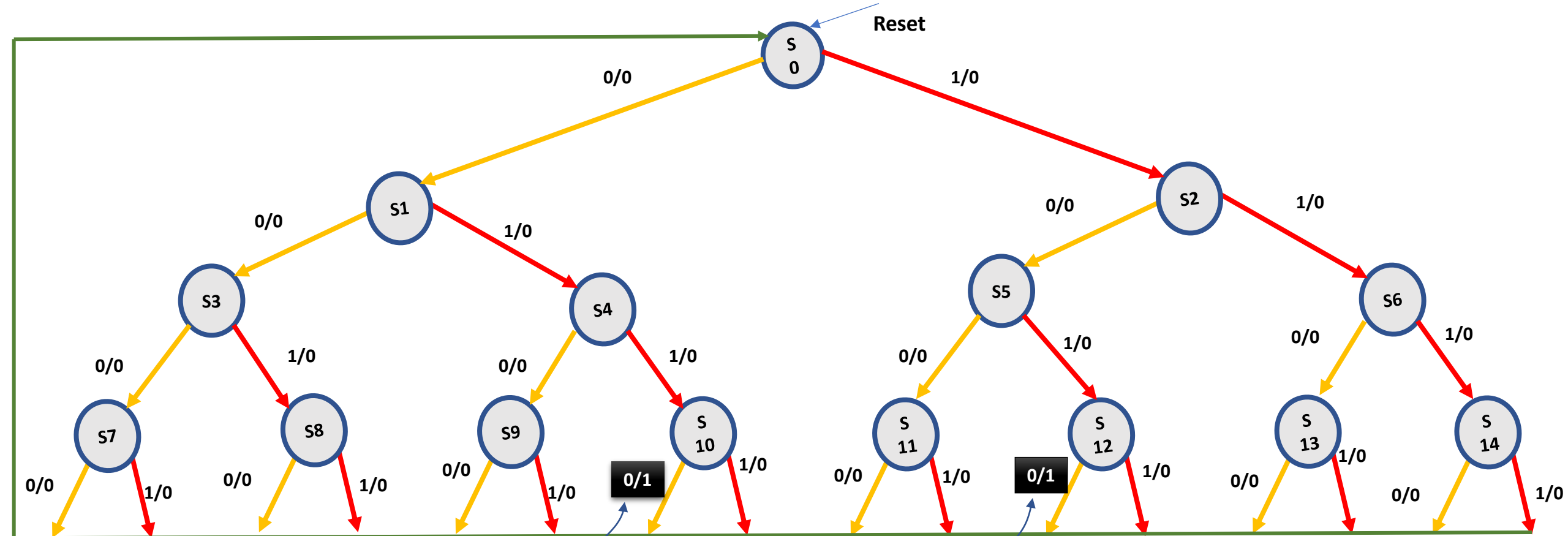
Assumptions:

Mealy Implementation

Example:

Input	X=	0010	0110	1100	1010	0011		
Output	Z =	0000	0001	0000	0001	0000		

Mealy State Machine for 4-Bit Sequence Detector



Look for Strings of "0110" or "1010" in serial input stream

Initial State Transition Table

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3	S4	0	0
1	S2	S5	S7	0	0
00	S3	S7	S8	0	0
01	S4	S9	S10	0	0
10	S5	S11	S12	0	0
11	S6	S13	S14	0	0
000	S7	S0	S0	0	0
001	S8	S0	S0	0	0
010	S9	S0	S0	0	0
011	S10	S0	S0	1	0
100	S11	S0	S0	0	0
101	S12	S0	S0	1	0
110	S13	S0	S0	0	0
111	S14	S0	S0	0	0

Examine table to find rows with identical next state and output values

Eg. We can combine S10 and S12; Both have same next state and same output

Merge S10 and S12 into one state "S10A" and make new table

Iteration:

States S7, S8, S9 and S11, S13, S14 have same Next states and same outputs; Hence these can be combined

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3	S4	0	0
1	S2	S5	S7	0	0
00	S3	S7	S8	0	0
01	S4	S9	S10	0	0
10	S5	S11	S12	0	0
11	S6	S13	S14	0	0
000	S7	S0	S0	0	0
001	S8	S0	S0	0	0
010	S9	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0
100	S11	S0	S0	0	0
110	S13	S0	S0	0	0
111	S14	S0	S0	0	0

Merge S7, S8, S9, S11, S13, S14 into one new State called S7A

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3	S4	0	0
1	S2	S5	S7	0	0
00	S3	S7	S8	0	0
01	S4	S9	S10	0	0
10	S5	S11	S12	0	0
11	S6	S13	S14	0	0
000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 111	S7A	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0

Replace S7, S8, S9, S11, S13, S14 with S7A in the table; Also S12 with S10A

Iteration:

States 00 and 11 have same Next State and Output (S3A)

States 01 and 10 have same Next State and Output (S4A)

Hence these are equivalent States

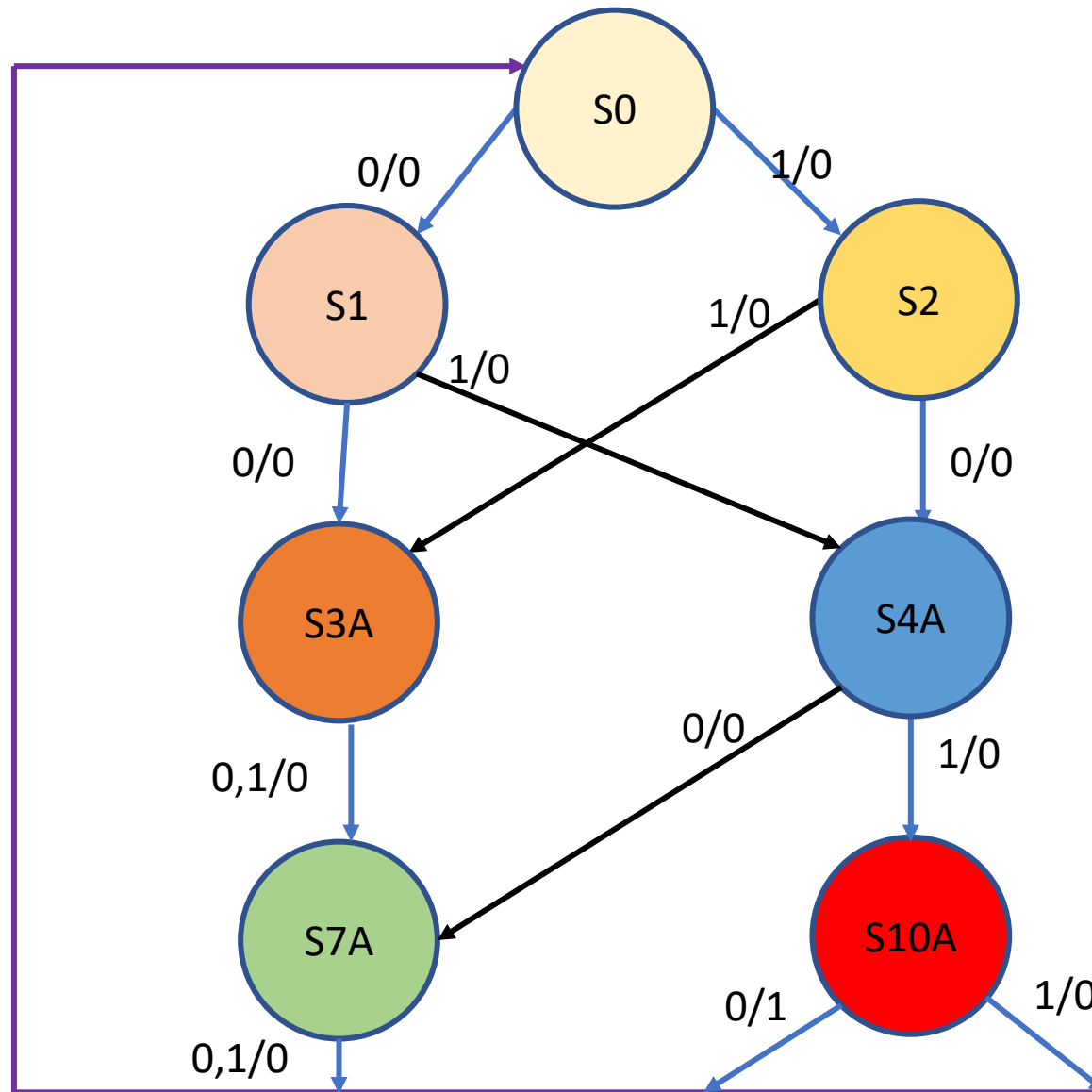
Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3	S4	0	0
1	S2	S5	S7A	0	0
00	S3	S7A	S7A	0	0
01	S4	S7A	S10A	0	0
10	S5	S7A	S10A	0	0
11	S6	S7A	S7A	0	0
000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 111	S7A	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0

Combine States S3 and S6 to S3A; Combine States S4 and S5 to S4A

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3A	S4A	0	0
1	S2	S4A	S7A	0	0
00, 11	S3A	S7A	S7A	0	0
01, 10	S4A	S7A	S10A	0	0
000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 111	S7A	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0

Final Reduced States are only 7:
S0, S1, S2, S3A, S4A, S7A, S10A

Final Reduced State Diagram



State Reduction using Implication Charts

- Graphical Technique for State Reduction
- Definition:
- Redundant State:
 - One state is equivalent to another (and hence redundant) if the state functions are in-distinguishable
- When all states that have (i) different next states and (ii) different outputs, have been identified, the remaining states are considered to be redundant

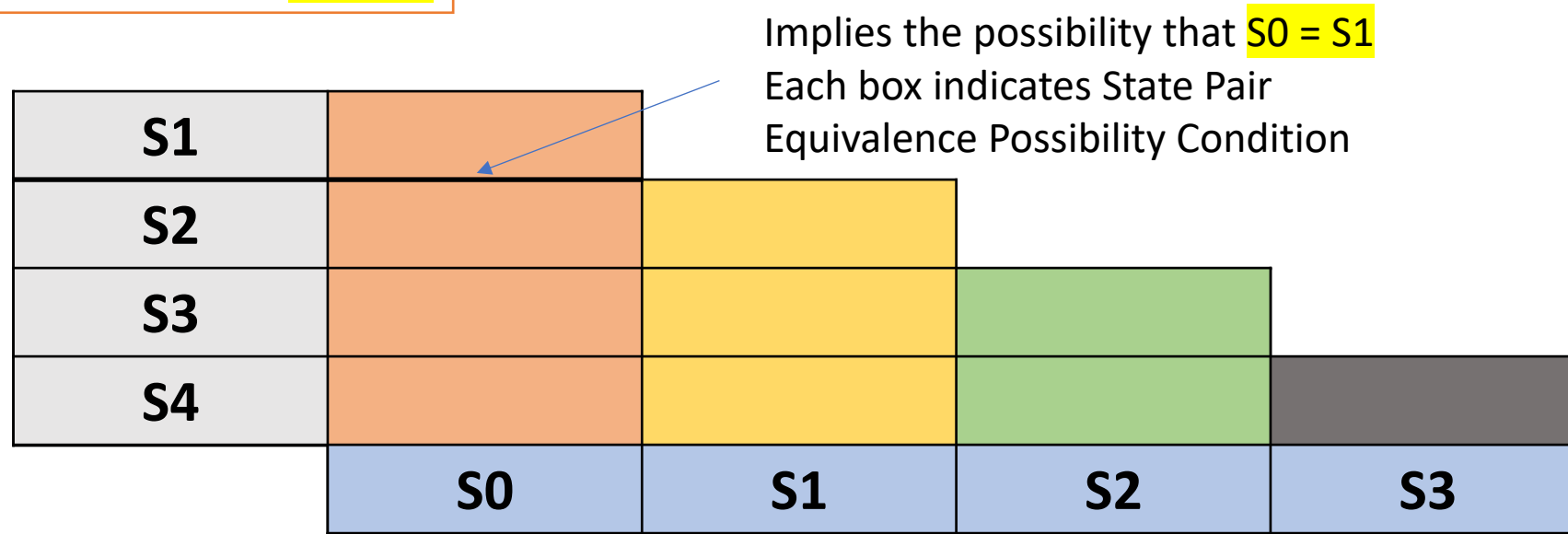
State Equivalence Theorem

- Two states SA and SB are equivalent iff for every possible input X sequence, the outputs are same and the next states are equivalent
- Properties of Equivalent States:
 - Symmetry: If $SA=SB$, then $SB=SA$
 - Reflexivity: $SA = SA$ for any state
 - Transitivity: If $SA=SB$, and $SB=SC$, then $SA=SC$

Construction of Implication Charts

The Chart is constructed by listing all of the states except the last, along horizontal axis, and Listing all of the states except the first, along the vertical axis
Intersection of the horizontal and vertical spaces indicates a possible state equivalence

Eg. Total States **S0 to S4**



Example of State Reduction using Implication Charts

Given the State Table as follows:

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

Total 6 states, S0 to S5

Filling the Implication Chart

- Place X in squares where outputs are different, as such states cannot be equivalent
- For other squares, we look at State Equivalence Pairs, i.e.:

- $S0 \equiv S2$, iff $S1 \equiv S3$

Thus we write S1,S3 in the square at intersection of S0, S2

$S0 \equiv S4$, iff $S2 \equiv S3$, and $S3 \equiv S5$

$S1 \equiv S5$, iff $S2 \equiv S3$

$S2 \equiv S4$, iff $S1 \equiv S5$

$S3 \equiv S5$, iff $S1 \equiv S5$, and $S1 \equiv S2$

Filled Implication Chart with conditions of equivalent states

S1	X				
S2	S1,S3	X			
S3	X	S1,S3	X		
S4	S2,S4 S3,S5	X	S2,S4 S1,S5	X	
S5	X	S1,S5 S2,S3	X	S1,S5 S1,S2	X
	S0	S1	S2	S3	S4

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

One by one, examine all table entries and refer to the state transition table

X is inserted where outputs of states is different

Check conditions of equivalence in respective squares

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

S1	X				
S2	S1,S3	X			
S3	X	S1,S3	X		
S4	S2,S4 S3,S5	X	S2,S4 S1,S5	X	
S5	X	S1,S5 S2,S3	X	S1,S5 S1,S2	X
	S0	S1	S2	S3	S4

To check for: {S1,S3}, {S1,S5}, {S2,S3}, {S1,S2}

To check for: {S1,S3}, {S1,S5}, {S2,S3}, {S1,S2}

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

In {S1,S3}:

Outputs are same for S1, and S3

In Next States, When X=1, S1 goes to S3 and S3 goes to S1

Hence S1 and S3 are equivalent

In {S1,S2}, output is different when X=1, hence these cannot Be equivalent, so this square will get 'X'

In {S2,S3}, output is different when X=1, hence these cannot be equivalent, so this square will be 'X'.

This means that S1 cannot be equivalent to S5 as it is dependent on S2 and S3 as Next State

Similarly, check all conditions in all squares

Updated Implication Chart

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

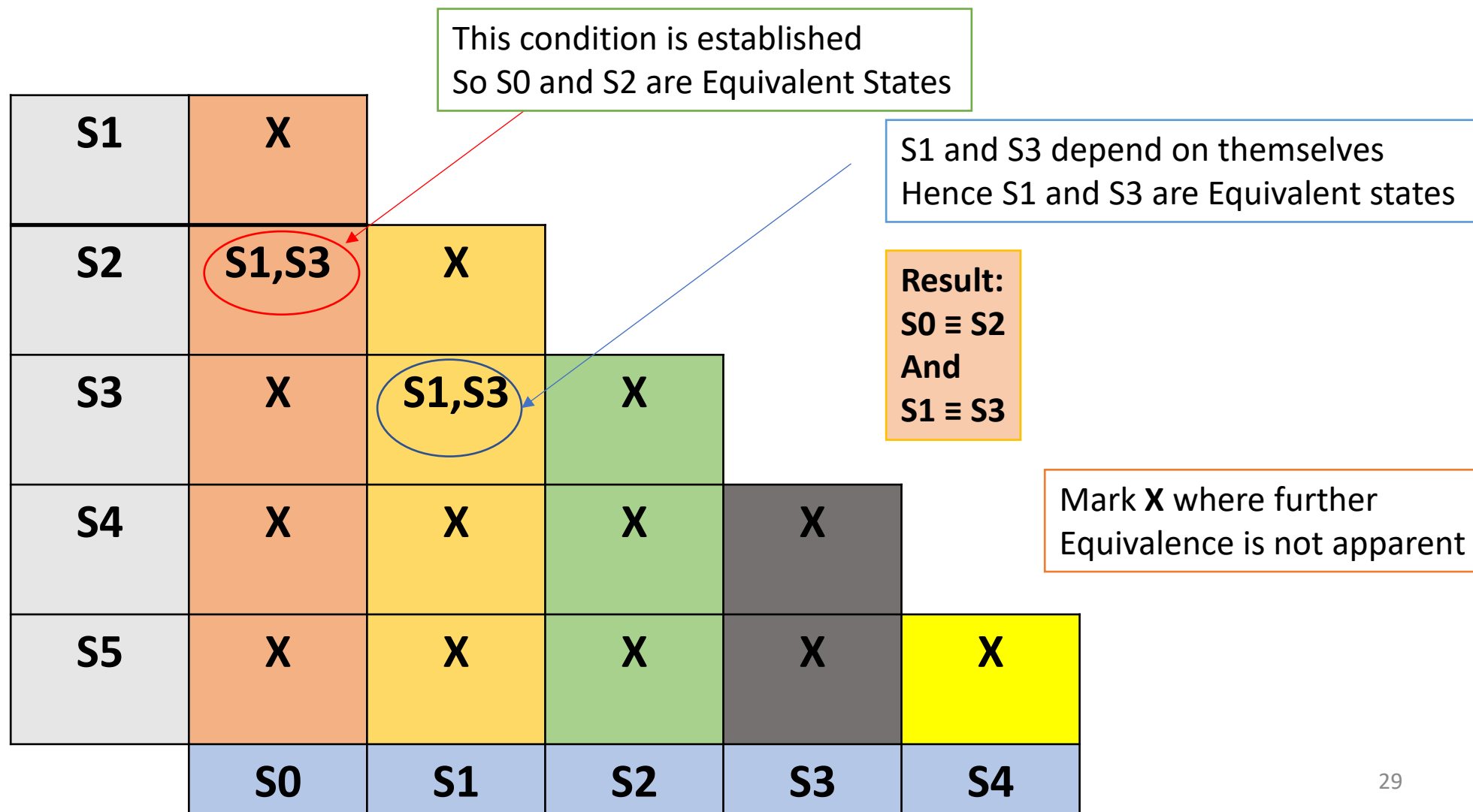
S1	X				
S2	S1,S3 ✓	X			
S3	X	S1,S3 ✓	X		
S4	S2,S4 S3,S5	X	S2,S4 S1,S5	X	
S5	X	S1,S5 S2,S3	X	S1,S5 S1,S2	X
	S0	S1	S2	S3	S4

This condition is established
So S0 and S2 are Equivalent States

S1 and S3 depend on themselves
Hence S1 and S3 are Equivalent states

Result:
S0 ≡ S2
And
S1 ≡ S3

Updated further - Implication Chart



Updated State Table

Original table with six states

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S3	0	1
S1	S5	S3	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S2	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S2	0	0

Only four states are left

Present State	Next State		Output	
	When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
S0	S4	S1	0	1
S1	S5	S1	0	0
S2	S4	S1	0	1
S3	S5	S1	0	0
S4	S0	S5	0	1
S5	S1	S0	0	0

Result:
S0 $\equiv$ S2
And
S1 $\equiv$ S3

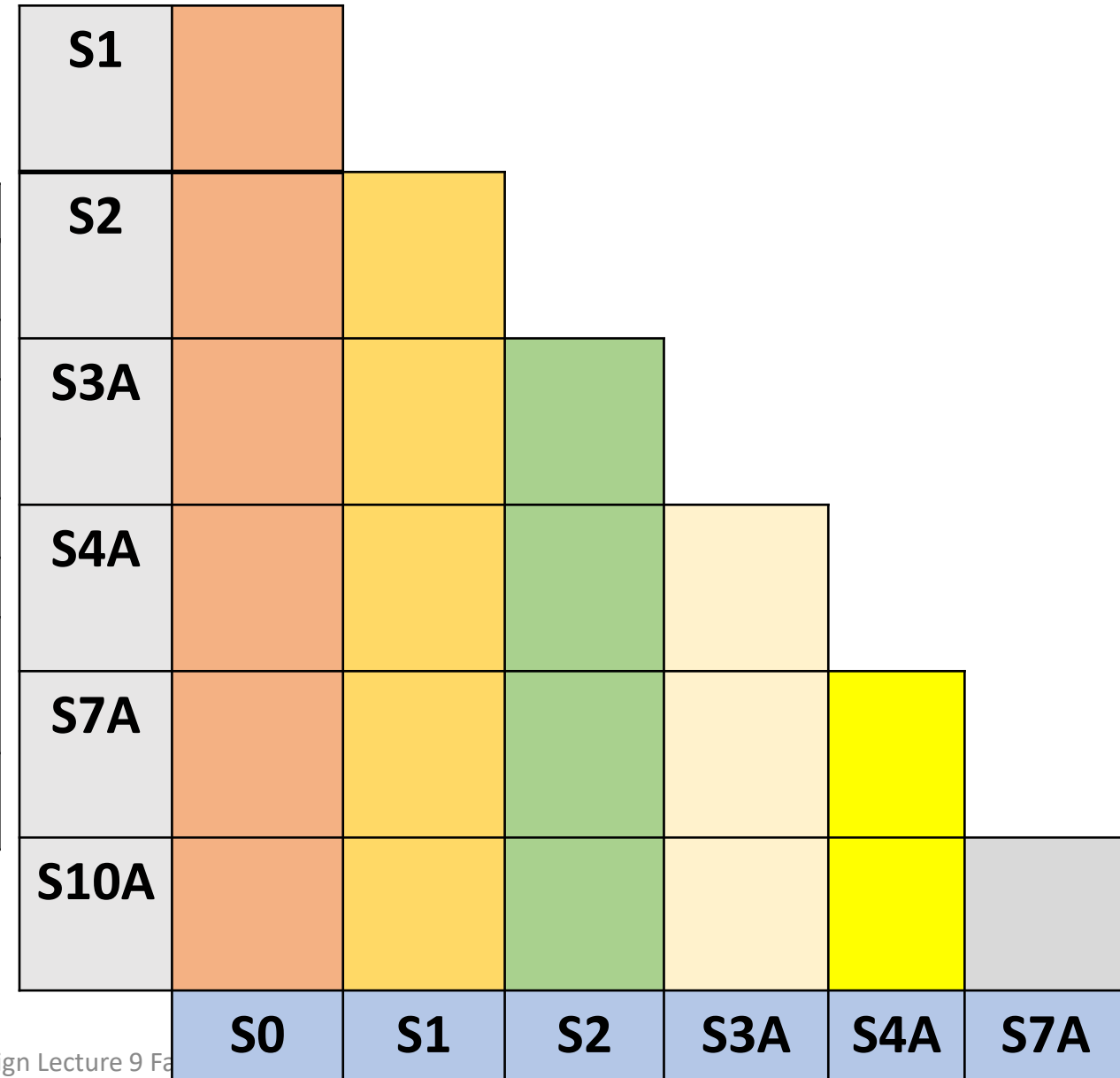


Practice Example: 4-Bit Sequence Detector

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3A	S4A	0	0
1	S2	S4A	S7A	0	0
00, 11	S3A	S7A	S7A	0	0
01, 10	S4A	S7A	S10A	0	0
000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 111	S7A	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0

See if states can be reduced further:

Input Sequence	Present State	Next State		Output	
		When X=0	When X=1	When X=0	When X=1
Reset	S0	S1	S2	0	0
0	S1	S3A	S4A	0	0
1	S2	S4A	S7A	0	0
00, 11	S3A	S7A	S7A	0	0
01, 10	S4A	S7A	S10A	0	0
000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 111	S7A	S0	S0	0	0
011 or 101	S10A	S0	S0	1	0

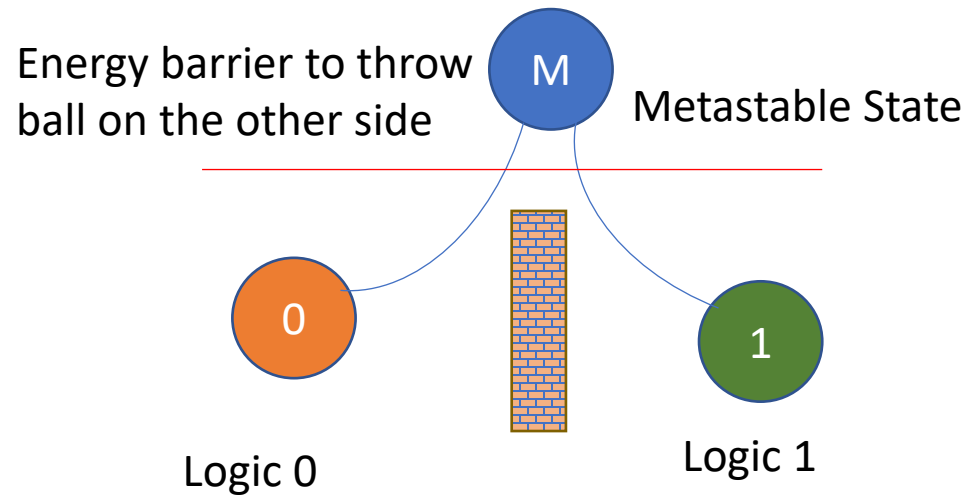


Filled Implication Chart

S1						
S2						
S3A						
S4A						
S7A						
S10A						
	S0	S1	S2	S3A	S4A	S7A

Metastability, and Asynchronous Data Management

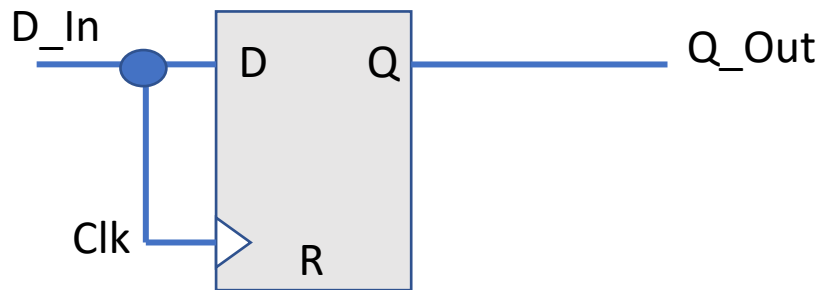
Objective – to reduce possible **Metastability** in capturing **Asynchronous Input**



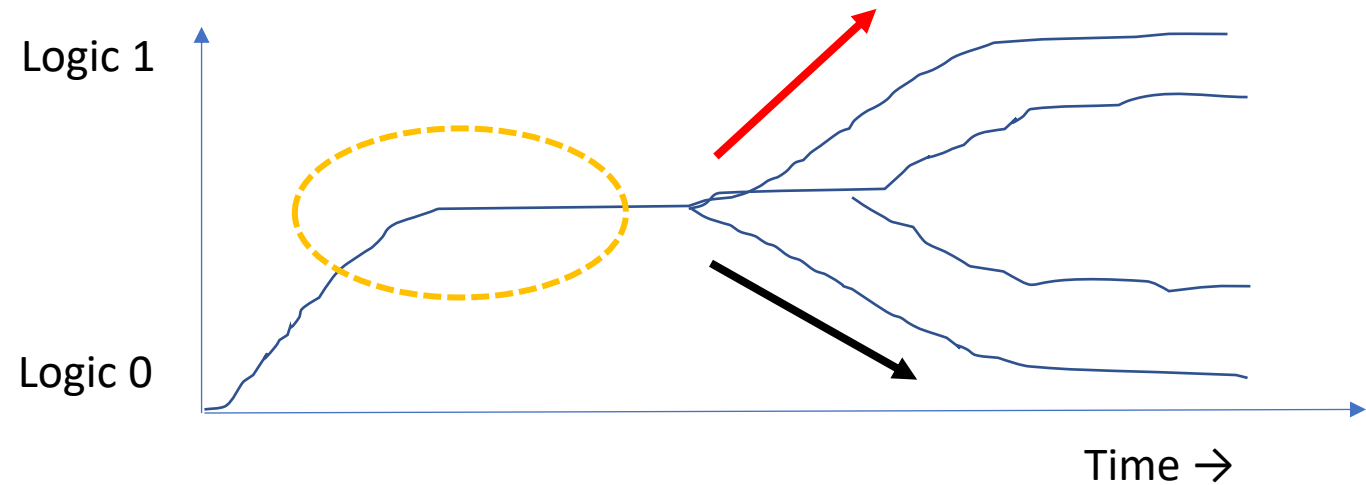
Synchronizer Failure: When flipflop hangs in a Metastable State for a long time (indefinitely)

Normally, the flipflop output would settle to a stable 0 or 1 state after some time

Output Behaviour with Metastability



**DFF is connected to produce metastability
As setup time is violated**



Oscilloscope trace of metastable behaviour

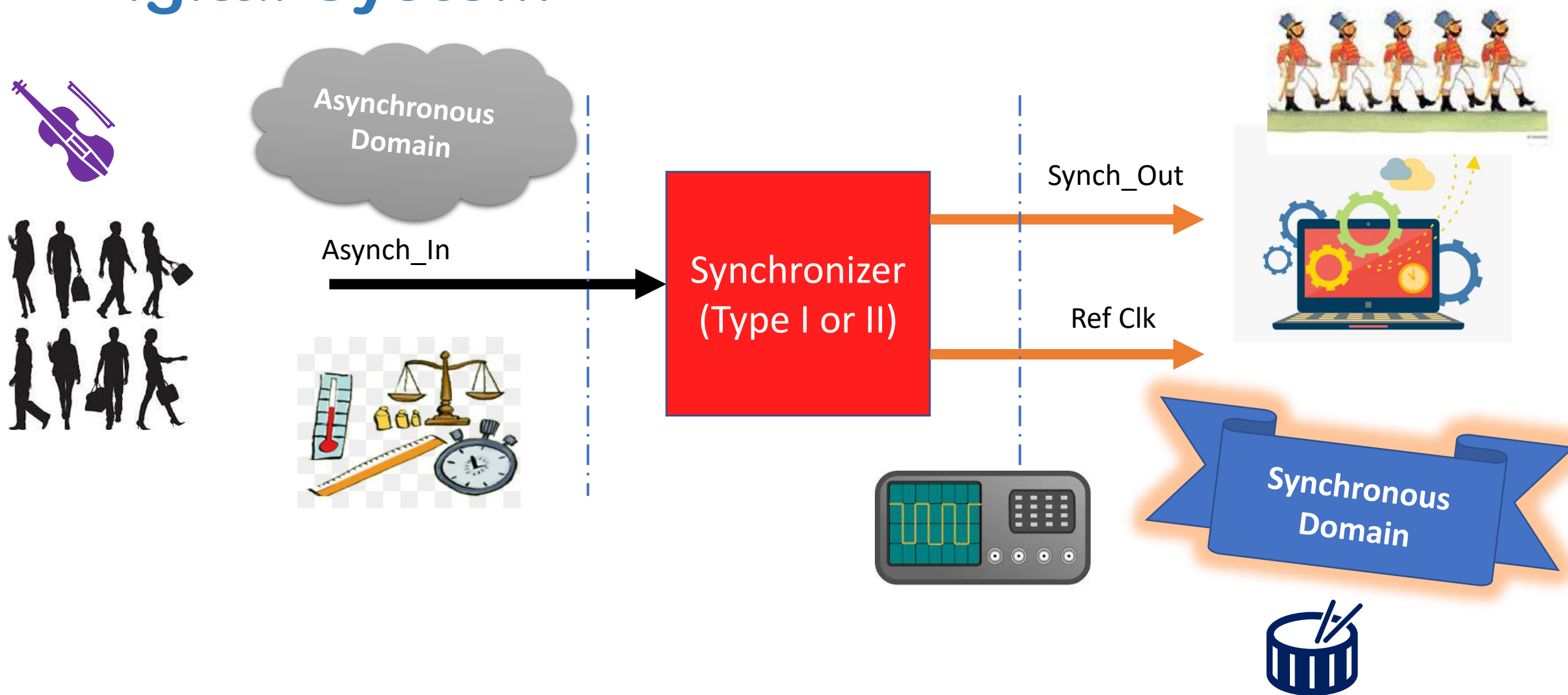
Eventually a stable state is reached

**Problem occurs when flipflop is not stable within
One clock period**

Synchronizers

- Asynchronous inputs are problematic as their transitions are not predictable
- High speed digital circuits rely on synchronizers to create a time buffer for recovering from a metastable event; thus reducing the possibility that metastability will cause circuit to malfunction
- An asynchronous signal should be synchronized by one synchronizer only. If not, then multiple synchronized signals could be present in the system and one of these could be driven into metastable state

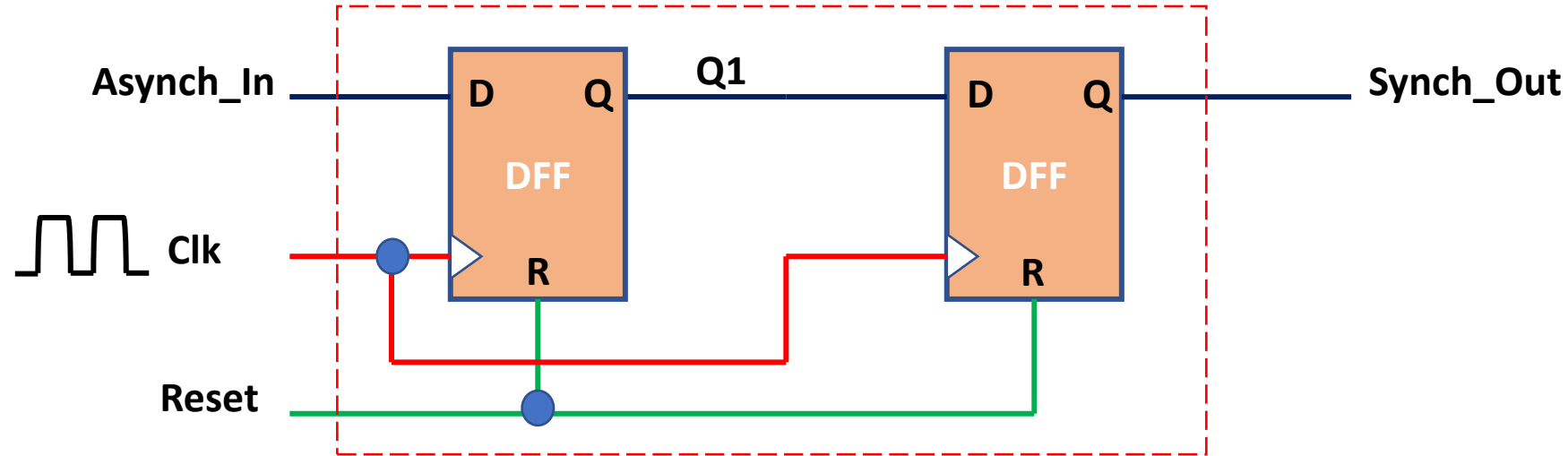
Asynchronous Inputs to a Synchronous Digital System



Synchronizer 1

Condition: The width of asynchronous input pulse is greater than period of the clock

Synchronizer is a multistage shift register



Reset Input 'R' is used as control to bring Synch_Out back to '0', as required